

505 East 79th Street
Shareholder Selected Nominees for the Board of Directors 2026 - 2027

Jonathan Berns

Jonathan Berns is an investment banker with over ten years of experience advising corporations and private equity clients on critical strategic and financing matters. He is currently a Director in the Leveraged Finance Investment Banking division at the Canadian Imperial Bank of Commerce, with prior experience at global platforms such as Barclays and Macquarie Capital.

Throughout his career, Jonathan has advised Fortune 500 companies and leading investors on strategic advisory assignments and the structuring and execution of financing transactions totaling tens of billions of dollars. Jonathan would bring skills pertaining to rigorous financial analysis, fiduciary duty, and people management, which are directly applicable to effective board oversight. He holds the Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) designation, which requires a strong foundation in ethics, financial analysis, and long-term stewardship. Jonathan's relevant experience also includes serving on the board of directors for the Hebrew Free Burial Association for five years.

Jonathan lives in the building with his wife and three children and is deeply invested in the co-op as both a resident and shareholder. He is committed to contributing thoughtful leadership to help ensure the building is transparent, collaborative, and welcoming to all residents.

Philip Braverman

Philip Braverman and his family have lived at 505 since 1995. He is a tax attorney and has worked in a variety of finance functions at leading consumer products and financial services companies since 1985. He has served on the Board for fifteen years, split into two periods of service.

Robert Brinberg

Robert Brinberg has lived at 505 East 79th Street for nine years with his wife and three children.

Mr. Brinberg has nearly 30 years of experience building and operating financial services firms. Currently, he is the President of Rose & Company, a capital markets advisory firm he co-founded in 2011. In his present role, he heads the firm's corporate advisory and financial communications practices, working with 100+ multi-national companies, and also oversees the firm's business operations. He previously served as Chief Operating Officer of Dahlman Rose & Company, a middle-market investment bank he helped build and manage from startup through sale to Cowen & Company in 2013. His responsibilities spanned finance, compliance, reporting, human resources, technology, operations, and corporate communications. He also served on the firm's Executive Committee, chaired its Administrative Committee, and was secretary of the Board of Managers of its parent company.

He would bring to the board a combination of strategic judgment, financial oversight, operating experience and discipline, and a strong belief in transparent, timely communication.

If elected, his priorities would be focused on maintaining a board that communicates more effectively, makes decisions more transparently, and operates with a clearer focus on shareholder interests, quality of life, and long-term co-op value.

Damian Britt

Damian Britt has been a shareholder of 505 East 79th Street since 2016. He is a Managing Director at an investment bank and former Senior Analyst at an economic consulting firm. He earned his BBA from Emory University and MBA from NYU. For over 20 years he has advised shareholders, creditors and regulators of financially distressed companies on investment and credit risk, financing options, forecasting, and negotiating with stakeholders. Clients span the real estate, insurance, technology, education and art industries.

Damian enjoys working collaboratively with others and believes his experience in financial analysis and assessing companies' financial options will assist with board-level decisions. Damian highly values transparency and prudent planning, and will advocate for exploring options to facilitate interactions among shareholders, and between shareholders and the managing agent. Damian believes the result will be a high sense of community, a welcoming environment for current and new shareholders, and ultimately higher property values. Damian Britt respectfully asks for your support and vote.

Mark Hasson

Mark Hasson and his wife have been residents at 505 for over thirty-nine years. He has served as Treasurer of the Board of Directors for the last twenty-three years. During his career he worked in senior financial positions at major media companies.

Jon Margareten

Jon Margareten is a licensed CPA, MBA and a practicing attorney who has successfully founded and operated multiple businesses. He currently advises dozens of corporations on operations, compliance, financial strategy, and governance, while regularly attending board meetings to provide strategic guidance. In addition, Jon runs a construction business in his spare time, where he has renovated multiple homes, gaining hands-on expertise in project management, contractor oversight, building maintenance, and cost control.

With his combined background in finance, law, business leadership, and construction, Jon brings practical skills in financial analysis, budgeting, risk management, and board-level decision making.

Jon is committed to transparency, open communication with all shareholders, and balancing short-term and long-term shareholder value. He strongly supports the families in the building and will work collaboratively to keep the coop financially strong, well-maintained, and a welcoming home for everyone.

Jon Margareten respectfully asks for your support and vote.

Alison Schlesinger

Alison Schlesinger and her family have lived at 505 for over twenty years. She has over twenty-five years experience working in education and consumer products. Alison spent several years as a consultant for McKinsey & Co. and more than decade as head of global strategy at Avon. She is currently the VP of New Educational Ventures at Sarah Lawrence College in Bronxville, N.Y. She has served on the Board for over twelve years.

Brett Silverstein

Brett Silverstein has lived in the building with his wife and their two young children since August 2023. They plan to be long-term residents and raise their family here.

He has spent 15 years in financial services, including over a decade at Bloomberg LP, where he is a Solution Engineer. He works with investors on time-sensitive projects like fund launches and system changes, where things have to get done right and on time. A big part of his job is introducing new processes without disrupting what's already working.

He would bring that same approach to the board, focused on being practical, thoughtful, and clear. From his own experience as a shareholder, he's seen that communication around major projects and building policies can be better, and believes shareholders should have a clearer understanding of what decisions are being made and why. While ongoing maintenance is important, he also thinks the building should continue looking for ways to improve long-term value and strengthen the sense of community.

Thank you for your consideration.

Charles Spielholz, PhD

Charlie Spielholz has been a resident of 505 since 1996. He is a biomedical research scientist focused on cancer. He has worked in the research divisions of the Sloan-Kettering Cancer Center and other institutions in the NY area. He consults to different entities. He has been secretary of the Co-op since 1999.
